



Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

Dealing with illegal questions in an interview.



## Learning Outcome

Identify and describe issues relating to money, in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

### Ask your partner:

- Have you ever been asked a question at a job interview you felt uncomfortable answering? What was it?
- What questions do you think are considered illegal in a job interview?

## Can Do Statements

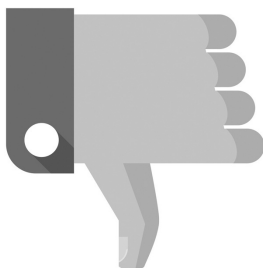
- I can exchange complex information about my work.
- I can talk about facts and courses of action.
- I can describe job requirements.





## Let's Explore!

Some questions should not be in an interview!



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

- Adam:** Mark, can we meet at the coffee shop in front of the job fair in 10 minutes?
- Mark:** Sure. See you in 10!
- Mark:** Adam, good to see you.
- Adam:** Sorry I'm late. I got tied up in another job search workshop.
- Mark:** What you need to do now is chill. Jobs are being advertised everywhere. People are being recruited. I'm sure you will land an interview soon.
- Adam:** Thanks, Mark. The thing I need the most now is to practice some mock interviews.
- Mark:** I can help with that. The most important thing to remember in an interview is to let them know what you have to offer. A lot of the people I train have been given jobs because they focus on that.
- Adam:** What I have problems with is some of the questions they ask. This guy once asked me about my nationality.
- Mark:** I can't believe these questions are still being asked. I know companies who have been penalized because of this discriminatory practice.
- Adam:** Interviews are stressful enough. One thing I wasn't aware of is that there are illegal interview questions.
- Mark:** What people need to understand is that they have rights. I'll help you dodge those questions.
- Adam:** So apart from nationality, what else is illegal to ask?
- Mark:** Questions about your religion are not permissible.
- Adam:** It's hard to believe interviewees are being put in a situation where they have to talk about their religious views.
- Mark:** A lot of these questions are being frowned upon lately. Here's another one: gender. I know people who have been asked if they think a woman can do a particular job effectively.
- Adam:** Wow. That's inadmissible.
- Mark:** The list is endless and I could go on for hours.
- Adam:** Do you think we could focus more on the "do's" and "don't's" in an interview?
- Mark:** Sure. Let me get some more coffee.





## Let's Practice!

Mark tells Adam the kinds of questions an employer should not ask.

*Instructions: Read the sentences and select all the Passive verb forms.*

1. Jobs are being advertised everywhere.
2. People are being recruited.
3. A lot of the people I train have been given jobs because they focus on that.
4. I can't believe these questions are still being asked.
5. It's hard to believe interviewees are being put in a situation where they have to talk about their religious views.
6. I know people who have been asked if they think a woman can do a particular job effectively.



## Let's Practice!

Mark and Adam discuss interviews.

*Instructions: Match the words from Column A to the words from Column B.*

### COLUMN A

1. What you need to
2. The thing I need the most now
3. The most important thing to remember in
4. What I have problems with is
5. One thing I wasn't aware

### COLUMN B

- a. do now is chill.
- b. of is that there are illegal interview questions.
- c. some of the questions they ask.
- d. is to practice some mock interview questions.
- e. an interview is to let them know what you have to offer.





## Extension Activity

Interview your friend

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Go online and research illegal interview questions and job interview questions.
- Choose and write 10 questions, 3 of which should be illegal questions.
- Ask your partner the questions.
- When you are finished, ask your partner to tell you which questions were illegal.
- Finally, talk about how you could've made the illegal questions better interview questions.

### Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research job interview questions.

☐ ☐

I write job interview questions.

☐ ☐

I report the questions that were asked.

☐ ☐

I talk about how the questions could have been rewritten to sound more legal.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- to get tied up** (expression): to become very busy  
e.g. Sorry I'm late, but I got tied up.
- to recruit** (verb): to persuade someone to work for an organization  
e.g. A lot of people are being recruited now.
- mock interview** (noun): an interview that is not real but is intended to look or seem real  
e.g. We need to practice some mock interviews.
- to penalize** (verb): to be punished for breaking a rule  
e.g. Companies who ask illegal questions should be penalized.
- discriminatory practice** (noun): treating people unfairly because of their religion, race or other personal features  
e.g. Asking questions about religion in an interview is a discriminatory practice.
- to dodge** (verb): to avoid doing something in a clever or dishonest way  
e.g. I'll help you dodge illegal questions.
- to be frowned upon** (expression): to disapprove of something  
e.g. These questions are frowned upon in interviews.
- inadmissible** (adjective): unable to be accepted  
e.g. That kind of question is inadmissible.
- endless** (adjective): seeming to have no end or limit  
e.g. The list is endless.
- permissible** (adjective): allowed to be done by a law or rule  
e.g. Questions about your religion are not permissible.





## Learning Points

### Passive of Present Continuous Tense and Present Perfect Tense

You use the Present Continuous You use the Present Continuous to talk about actions that are happening now, at the moment of speaking.

You use the Present Perfect to talk about an action or event in the past that is important now or has consequences now. The Present Perfect alerts you to the connection between the past event and the present.

You often choose the passive form of a tense when you want to talk about an action but are not so interested in saying who or what does/did it. Passives without *agents* (the doers) are common in academic and scientific writing.

Look at the chart below for the structure of the passive voice.

| Name               | Structure                           | Example                                                                   |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Present Continuous | am/are/is + being + past participle | <i>Jobs are being advertised everywhere.</i>                              |
| Present Perfect    | have/has + been + past participle   | <i>I know companies who have been penalized because of this practice.</i> |

### Examples:

- People are being recruited.
- I can't believe these questions are still being asked.
- A lot of the people I train have been given jobs because they focus on that.
- It's hard to believe interviewees are being put in a situation where they have to talk about their religious views.
- A lot of these questions are being frowned upon lately.





## Learning Points

### What Clauses and Long Phrases as Subjects

When you use a *what*, *that*, or *who* clause as the subject of a sentence, you have shifted the emphasis away from the words that sit in the subject position.

Look at these examples:

#### Original Sentence

*You really need to relax.*

#### Noun Clause Sentence

***What you really need to do now*** is relax.

A “*what*-phrase” is composed of: what + pronoun + verb phrase

Example:

“What-phrases” are often used to:

- *introduce a new topic*
- *give reasons, instructions, or explanations*
- *correct something that has been said or done.*

Apart from “what-phrases”, we can also use long noun phrases as the subject. A phrase is two or more words and it can include a noun and/or a verb. They are very similar to “what-phrases” but they don't start with “what”.

The thing I need the most now is to practice some mock interviews.

The most important thing to remember in an interview is to let them know what you have to offer.

One thing I wasn't aware of is that there are illegal interview questions.

#### Examples:

- *The thing I need the most now is to practice some mock interviews.*
- *The most important thing to remember in an interview is to let them know what you have to offer.*
- *One thing I wasn't aware of is that there are illegal interview questions.*

